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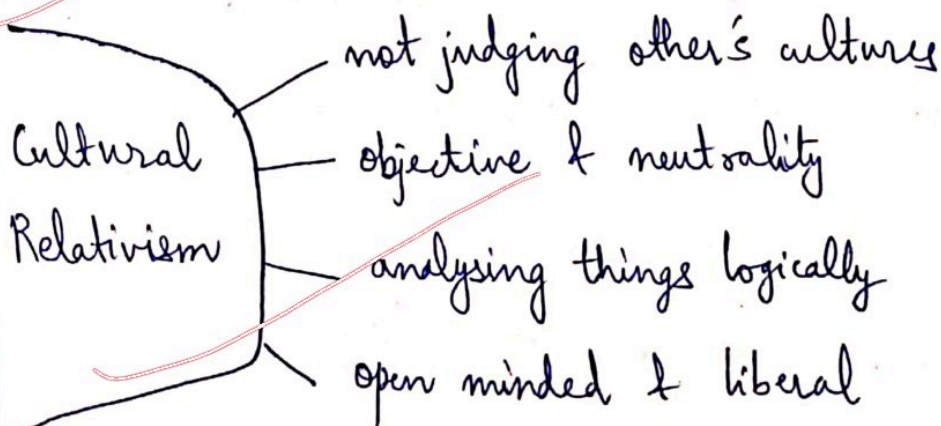
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(c) Discuss why cultural relativism has been so dear to Anthropologists

Cultural relativism refers to studying a culture through logic and meanings of that culture only which is under observation.

Development and Background

- 1) Franz Boas the proponent of historical particularism argued that ~~every historical~~ process of every culture has evolved through a particular historic process.
- 2) Hence, culture should be viewed from the lens of that culture itself.



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Dear to Anthropologist Because

- 1) It promotes tolerance and harmony within society by reducing inter-group conflicts.
- 2) It helps us to understand human differences by busting the myths of social ~~superiority~~ & cultural superiority.
- 3) Applied anthropology : It can help in policy making and administration especially tribal areas affected with left wing extremism in India.
- 4) Promotes & preserve human culture by helping conserve tribal languages.

- 5) Paul Rosenblatt - cultural relativism can help reform societies by inculcating best practices.
- 6) It can help promote world peace.
- 7) Cultural relativism can help open new vistas of knowledge.

Criticism Elizabeth Zacherer argued that cultural relativism promotes traditional practices which are violative of human rights. eg: Female genital mutilation in middle east

Despite criticism, cultural relativism has helped develop anthropology & it has become one of the hallmarks of fieldwork tradition.

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